

For Children & Teens: SandCastles

A safe, caring place for grieving children, teens, and their families.

Children grieve differently than adults — in bursts, through play, and with big questions. **SandCastles** is Henry Ford’s grief support program created to give children and teens, and the adults who love them, a place to grieve together and know they are not alone.

What SandCastles offers

- Year-round peer support groups for ages 3–18, in person and virtual
- Groups that gather children close in age to share, learn, and heal through creative expression, games, and mindfulness
- An annual overnight summer camp for grieving children and teens
- Education and support for schools and community organizations

Services reach families across Wayne, Oakland, and Macomb counties and beyond.

Connect with SandCastles

Call **313-771-7005** to enroll, or email **sandcastles@hfhs.org** with questions. Learn more at **aboutsandcastles.org**.

Helping a grieving child

- Use simple, honest words like “died” rather than “passed away” or “lost,” which can confuse younger children.
- Let them ask the same questions more than once; repetition is how children make sense of loss.
- Keep routines where you can — predictability feels safe.

- Let them see your feelings; it gives them permission to have their own.

More children's grief resources

- Ele's Place — grief centers across Michigan (elesplace.org)
- The National Alliance for Children's Grief (childrengrieve.org)
- The Dougy Center (dougy.org)

Developed by the Central Autopsy Service at Henry Ford Health. An initiative led by **Pamela Holmes-Hill** and **Troy Shaffer**. Website and content by **Omar Z. Baba, MD**.